Restaurant-Style Salsa Roja

Ingredients

Whole peeled tomatoes . 28 oz. can
White onion . . . . . 1/2 medium
Garlic cloves 5
Jalapeños 4
Serrano chile 1
Fresh cilantro . . . . . 1/3 cup
Lime juice . . . . . from 1/2 lime
Ground cumin . . . . . 1 tsp.
Kosher salt . . . . . 1 Tbsp.

San Marzano or other whole peeled tomatoes, undrained. Strip seeds and ribs from the chiles for milder heat.

Directions

Roughly chop the **onion**, **garlic**, **jalapeños**, **serrano**, and **cilantro** — Juice 1/2 **lime** — Measure 1 tsp. **cumin** and 1 Tbsp. **kosher salt**

1. Add the **tomatoes** with their juice, chopped **onion**, **garlic**, **jalapeños**, **serrano**, **cilantro**, **lime juice**, 1 tsp. **cumin**, and 1 Tbsp. **kosher salt** to a food processor.
2. Pulse in short bursts until the salsa reaches the texture you want, from chunky to nearly smooth. Stop and scrape the sides once or twice. The mixture should look even, with bits of chile and cilantro still visible. Do not run the processor continuously—that turns the salsa thin and foamy.
3. Taste. The salsa should taste tomato-forward, spicy, and well salted, with a warm cumin note and a clean lime finish. Add more **salt** or **lime juice** as needed. For thicker dip, pour off a splash of liquid from the can before blending next time, or drain a spoonful from the finished salsa.
4. Rest *15–30 minutes* so the flavors marry. Taste again and adjust **salt** if needed. Serve at cool room temperature. Best within a few hours; refrigerates up to *5 days*. Stir before serving—it settles as it sits.